



UNITED STATES
NUCLEAR REGULATORY COMMISSION
REGION III
2056 WESTINGS AVENUE, SUITE 400
NAPERVILLE, IL 60563-2657

January 20, 2026

Michael Mlynarek
Site Vice President
Palisades Energy, LLC
Palisades Nuclear Plant
27780 Blue Star Memorial Highway
Covert, MI 49043-9530

SUBJECT: PALISADES NUCLEAR PLANT - RESTART SECURITY INSPECTION REPORT
05000255/2025404

Dear Mike Mlynarek:

On December 8, 2025, the U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC) completed an inspection at Palisades Nuclear Plant and discussed the results of this inspection with Dan Gagnon, Director of Security, and other members of your staff. The results of this inspection are documented in the enclosed report.

No findings or violations of more than minor significance were identified during this inspection.

On June 13, 2022, Palisades ceased permanent power operations and subsequently removed all fuel from the reactor, as detailed in the letter from Entergy to the NRC, "Certifications of Permanent Cessation of Power Operations and Permanent Removal of Fuel from the Reactor Vessel," (ADAMS Accession No. [ML22164A067](#)). On September 28, 2023, Holtec Decommissioning International, LLC (Holtec) submitted a letter to the NRC requesting exemptions from certain portions of the requirements of Title 10 of the *Code of Federal Regulations* (10 CFR) 50.82(a)(2) to pursue the potential reauthorization of power operations at Palisades (ADAMS Accession No. [ML23271A140](#)).

On July 24, 2025, the NRC approved an exemption from the requirements of 10 CFR 50.82(a)(2), as detailed in the letter, "Palisades Nuclear Plant - Exemption from the Requirements of 10 CFR 50.82(a)(2) Concerning the Prohibition to Operate and Emplace Fuel in the Reactor Vessel," (ADAMS Accession No. [ML25163A182](#)) and a set of licensing actions supporting reauthorization of Palisades Nuclear Plant. On August 25, 2025, Palisades notified the NRC that they rescinded their 10 CFR 50.82(a)(1) certification, which removed the prohibition on operation and emplacement of fuel in the reactor (ADAMS Accession No. [ML25237A317](#)). Palisades also implemented the set of licensing actions to support reimplementing of their operational licensing basis.

On August 25, 2025, the NRC transitioned oversight of Palisades to the Reactor Oversight Process (ROP).

This letter, its enclosure, and your response (if any) will be made available for public inspection and copying at <http://www.nrc.gov/reading-rm/adams.html> and at the NRC Public Document Room in accordance with Title 10 of the *Code of Federal Regulations* 2.390, "Public Inspections, Exemptions, Requests for Withholding."

Sincerely,



Signed by Ziolkowski, Michael
on 01/20/26

Michael E. Ziolkowski, Chief
Security, Emergency Preparedness, and Incident
Response Branch
Division of Radiological Safety and Security

Docket No. 05000255
License No. DPR-20

Enclosure:
As stated

cc w/ encl: Distribution via LISTSERV

Letter to M. Mlynarek from M. Ziolkowski dated January 20, 2026.

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05000255/2025404

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ADAMS ACCESSION NUMBER: ML26013A162

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**U.S. NUCLEAR REGULATORY COMMISSION
Inspection Report**

Docket Number: 05000255

License Number: DPR-20

Report Number: 05000255/2025404

Enterprise Identifier: I-2025-404-0013

Licensee: Holtec Decommissioning International, LLC

Facility: Palisades Nuclear Plant

Location: Covert, MI

Inspection Dates: June 16, 2025, to December 08, 2025

Inspectors: K. Hussar, Sr Physical Security Inspector, RGN I
S. Cavanaugh, Physical Security Inspector, RGN III
K. Maloney, Sr Physical Security Inspector, RGN III

Approved By: Michael E. Ziolkowski, Chief
Security, Emergency Preparedness, and Incident Response Branch
Division of Radiological Safety and Security

Enclosure

SUMMARY

The U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC) continued monitoring the licensee's performance by conducting a Restart Security Inspection at Palisades Nuclear Plant, in accordance with the Reactor Oversight Process. The Reactor Oversight Process is the NRC's program for overseeing the safe operation of commercial nuclear power reactors. Refer to <https://www.nrc.gov/reactors/operating/oversight.html> for more information.

List of Findings and Violations

No findings or violations of more than minor significance were identified.

Additional Tracking Items

None.

INSPECTION SCOPES

Inspections were conducted using the appropriate portions of the inspection procedures (IPs) in effect at the beginning of the inspection unless otherwise noted. Currently approved IPs with their attached revision histories are located on the public website at

<http://www.nrc.gov/readingrm/doc-collections/insp-manual/inspection-procedure/index.html>.

Samples were declared complete when the IP requirements most appropriate to the inspection activity were met consistent with Inspection Manual Chapter (IMC) 2562, "Light-Water Reactor Inspection Program for Restart of Reactor Facilities Following Permanent Cessation of Power Operations," which states, in part, that the U.S. Nuclear Regulatory Commission (NRC) will ensure that operational readiness has been reasonably verified across the reactor oversight process (ROP) cornerstones of safety and security.

OTHER ACTIVITIES - TEMPORARY INSTRUCTIONS, INFREQUENT AND ABNORMAL

81000.04 - Equipment Performance, Testing, and Maintenance

The inspectors evaluated the equipment performance, testing and maintenance program through completion of the following procedure elements:

Equipment Performance, Testing, and Maintenance (3 Sample)

- (1) 02.02.d; 02.06.f; 02.09

These samples, combined with the samples documented in Inspection report 5000255/2025403, dated July 24, 2025 (ML25205A048), constitute completion of Inspection Procedure 81000.04.

81000.05 - Protective Strategy Evaluation

The inspectors evaluated the licensee's Protective Strategy through completion of the following procedure elements:

Protective Strategy Evaluation (40 Sample)

- (1) All elements

81000.14 - Review of New Power Reactor Target Sets

The inspectors evaluated the licensee's Target Set program through completion of the following procedure elements:

Review of New Power Reactor Target Sets (1 Sample)

(1) 03.03 b

These samples, combined with the samples documented in Inspection report 5000255/2025403, dated July 24, 2025 (ML25205A048), constitute completion of Inspection Procedure 81000.14.

INSPECTION RESULTS

No findings were identified.

EXIT MEETINGS AND DEBRIEFS

The inspectors verified no proprietary information was retained or documented in this report.

- On December 8, 2025, the inspectors presented the Restart Security Inspection results to Dan Gagnon and other members of the licensee staff.

DOCUMENTS REVIEWED

Inspection Procedure	Type	Designation	Description or Title	Revision or Date
81000.04	Miscellaneous		Shadow Tec Advanced Video Patrol System Operator Powerpoint	0
			Operability Testing Job Aid	2
	Procedures	Early Warning System	Camera View Images	12/01/2025
		Early Warning System	Standing Order	2
81000.05	Corrective Action Documents Resulting from Inspection	25010961		08/04/2025
	Procedures	OCA Area Patrols	OCA Area Patrols	REV 1
		PL 0025	Vital Area Patrols	REV 15
		PL 0029	PA Manhole Patrols	REV 4
		PL 0031	South OCA Patrol	REV 9
		PL0022	IMP Patrols	07/16/2025
		PL0026	Protected Area Patrols	REV 9
		PL0027	DFS Protected Area Patrols	REV 1